

Global Bank Strategy: Deep Research Report

Decision-ready synthesis: The evidence supports a Dallas-based, U.S.-first financial group positioned near the Texas Stock Exchange (TXSE), but not a single-entity universal bank launch. The best-fit structure is a U.S. bank holding company with a nationally supervised bank subsidiary for deposits and lending, plus separate registered broker-dealer and investment adviser subsidiaries for securities and advice [source-us-sec-1]. That structure aligns with the distinct regulatory regimes for banking, brokerage, and advice, and reduces perimeter risk versus trying to bundle all products in one entity [source-us-sec-1].

Market opportunity is real, but economics differ sharply by product. U.S. banking remains enormous, with about \$23.7T of assets and \$17.7T of deposits in Q4 2023; yet spread economics are thin, with 2025:Q2 ROE at 10.26% and net interest margin at 2.58%, and noninterest income only 1.95% of assets [source-us-banking]. That argues for deposits and cash management as relationship anchors, not the main profit engine. The most attractive fee pools are in wealth, advisory, payments, and trading-linked services [source-us-banking].

The clearest unmet retail opportunity is in underbanked and mass-affluent customers. Public statistics cited in the specialist evidence indicate 5.7M U.S. households were unbanked and 12.2M underbanked in 2023, with materially higher unbanked rates among Black and Hispanic households [source-us-financial-services]. This supports a digitally native offering built around low-cost checking/savings, faster payments, credit-building, and human advice. Wealth demand is also strong: the U.S. asset-management industry grew at a 7.1% CAGR from 2018 to 2023, and wealth-management services generated about \$1.2T in revenue in 2022 [source-us-financial-services].

Cross-border demand exists, but it is most compelling where clients need custody, settlement, FX, treasury, and regulatory triage rather than simple onshore products. BIS reported global cross-border bank claims of \$45T at end-Q3 2025, with credit to borrowers in the United States up \$284B in the quarter and developed Europe up \$225B [source-bis-cross-border]. By contrast, cross-border bank credit to China fell by \$48B in Q3 2025, reinforcing that China-linked activity is more constrained and compliance-sensitive [source-bis-cross-border]. The bank should therefore treat Europe and especially China as phased expansion markets, not day-one retail operating bases [source-dechert-cross-border].

TXSE improves the Dallas strategic case, but it should be treated as an ecosystem advantage rather than a dependency. The SEC approved TXSE's Form 1 registration, making it a registered national securities exchange [source-txse-sec]. TXSE says it is headquartered in Dallas and is building a phased launch around trading, listings, and ETPs [source-txse-fact-sheet] [source-txse-clifford]. However, NYSE and Nasdaq still define liquidity and credibility for public-company clients, so the bank should not anchor its model on TXSE volume migration [source-txse-sec] [source-txse-clifford]. Instead, use Dallas/TXSE proximity to win issuer relationships, pre-IPO readiness, dual-listing advice, capital-formation work, and public-company services [source-txse-fact-sheet].

Recommended business model: launch as a U.S.-chartered bank-led wealth-and-cash-management platform in Dallas, with a partner-assisted market-access stack at first [source-us-sec-1] [s6] [s7]. Priority sequencing should be 1) checking and savings, 2) retirement and self-directed brokerage, 3) advisory, 4) SME cash management and lending, and 5) treasury services for cross-border firms [s1] [s2] [s3] [s4]. This sequencing matches the control burden: deposits are operationally simpler, brokerage/advice require suitability and surveillance, SME onboarding adds beneficial-ownership complexity, and treasury/cross-border payments carry the highest sanctions and monitoring load [s2] [s3] [s4] [source-dechert-cross-border].

Regulatory feasibility is manageable only with ring-fenced entities and phased geography. In the U.S., SEC materials emphasize that advisers register via Form ADV and that the SEC does not endorse the filing; broker-dealers must maintain AML programs, customer identification, beneficial ownership processes,

suspicious-activity monitoring, and sanctions screening [source-us-sec-1] [secaml1]. FINRA likewise highlights account takeover, suspicious money movement, ransomware, phishing, fake IDs, and deepfakes as active threats, and calls for AML controls, independent testing, training, and a designated AML officer [s3] [s4]. EU rules are product- and country-specific, with MiFID II/MiFIR, PSD2, PRIIPs, DORA, and EU-wide AML frameworks shaping cross-border activity [source-eu-1] [source-eu-2] [source-eu-3]. China is the most restrictive jurisdiction: CSRC and NFRA oversee securities and banking/insurance, while Chinese banking/insurance data-security rules require lifecycle governance, data classification, annual risk assessments, and tight controls on overseas transfers [source-cn-1] [source-cn-2] [source-cn-3].

Operating model recommendation: build the customer experience layer, risk orchestration, data/analytics, and case management in-house; partner initially for custody, clearing, payments rails, KYC document verification, sanctions screening, and market data [s2] [s4] [fdtarule1]. For launch, the firm should use digital-first onboarding, remote relationship management for affluent and SME clients, and a visible Dallas flagship near TXSE for issuer and institutional credibility [source-txse-fact-sheet]. Core governance should include a group CCO, AML officer, product-approval committee, model-risk lead, and data-governance committee, because the cited regimes all impose continuous obligations rather than one-time approvals [source-us-sec-1] [source-eu-2] [source-cn-1].

Bottom line: this is commercially attractive if—and only if—the bank focuses on a U.S.-first integrated banking + wealth proposition, sequences products by regulatory complexity, and treats Europe/China as later-stage, locally licensed expansion programs. The winning wedge is low-cost deposits and cash management; the margin expansion comes from brokerage, advice, treasury, and issuer services [source-us-banking] [source-txse-fact-sheet].

Recommended Banking Services

Recommended Banking Services: Launch Sequence and Portfolio Priority

1. Launch first: checking, savings, and cash management.

These products are the best relationship wedge because they create primary accounts, funding stability, and frequent digital engagement while keeping the initial operating burden manageable [source-us-banking].

2. Launch second: retirement accounts and self-directed brokerage.

This captures mass-affluent and affluent demand for tax-advantaged saving and investing, and builds recurring fee income without immediately requiring full discretionary advice infrastructure [source-us-financial-services] [s6].

3. Launch third: advisory services.

Advisory has the highest household revenue potential, but it also carries the highest suitability, disclosure, and documentation burden, so it should be added after brokerage controls and surveillance mature [s2] [s3].

4. Launch fourth: SME cash management and lending.

SME products can deepen relationships and improve economics, but business onboarding adds beneficial-ownership complexity, fraud risk, and underwriting effort [s2] [s3].

5. Launch last: treasury services and cross-border payments.

These are attractive for multinational clients, but they are the most operationally intensive because they require stronger sanctions screening, transaction monitoring, correspondent controls, and cross-border compliance [s2] [s4] [source-dechert-cross-border].

Practical rule: build deposits + brokerage + advice as the core platform, then add SME and cross-border capabilities only after AML, fraud, and data-governance controls are proven in production [source-us-sec-1] [source-cn-1].

Sources

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